

presence. Check all your sites at least twice a day, untagging as needed. Last but not least: Google-stalk yourself by setting an alert that tells you whenever your name pops up on the web. What pictures pop up? What personal information? If you find anything even borderline inappropriate, delete it immediately, if possible.

Here's the plus side: use social media well and you look better than other job candidates out there. In the second part of the CareerBuilder survey, 19 percent of the hiring managers said they found something on a social networking site that had caused them to hire a candidate. Topmost among them were candidates who displayed a professional image, about whom the recruiter felt like they got a good feel for his or her personality. Other pluses were candidates who were clearly well rounded, demonstrated great communication skills and had qualifications that matched up with the ones on their résumé.

It isn't just prospective employers who are reviewing what I like to call your "social résumé." When you submit an application for a car loan or a new credit card, those companies are browsing your social media history, too. There are three pillars that go into their decision-making process. The first two have always existed: your track record of employment and your credit score. But the third pillar is a completely new element: the wild, wild world of social media. If you're in alcoholic binge party groups, it's not going to help you get credit.

Your social résumé is a hidden résumé. You'll never know who looks at it. That swimsuit picture or funny one-liner you post is going to be a part of your digital profile *for the rest of your life*. Today's web landscape is unforgiving and unforgetting; spiders scrape everything and keep it. Just because you *think* something is gone from the web does not mean it is gone. Don't let your online past come back to haunt you.

Money Mistake: *You're Going to Grad School to Avoid the Real World*
The Fix: *Follow Dollars, Not Degrees*